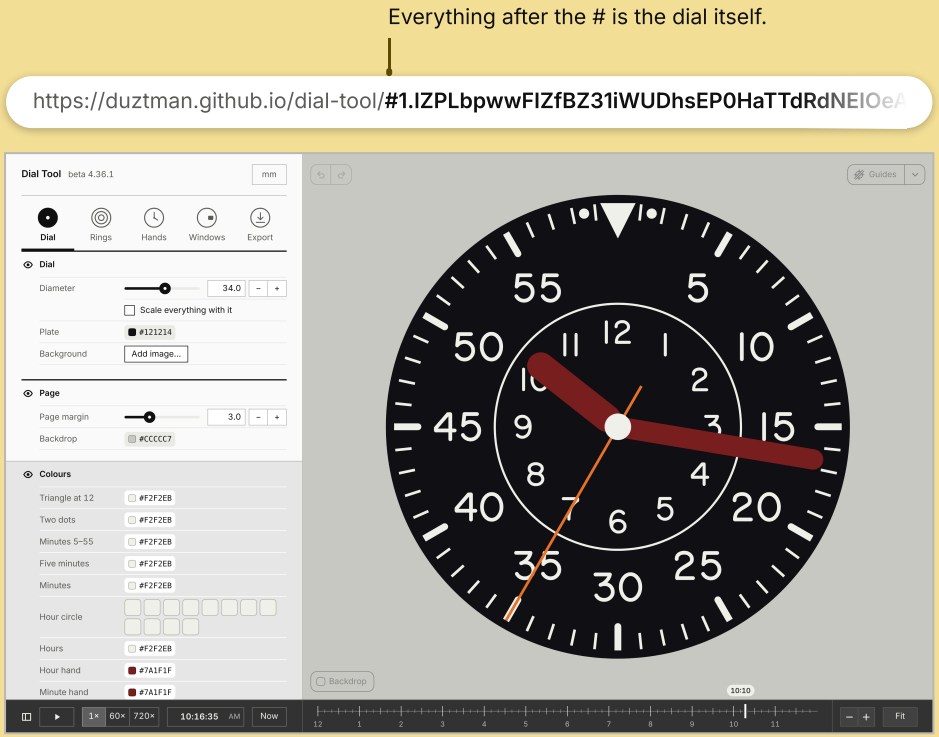
Start

Open the address and start drawing.
Nothing to install, nothing to sign up for.





Top right of the panel: closed, then open



The same dial's link, in the Export tab

Where it runs. The tool is one web page, duztman.github.io/dial-tool. It is tested in Chrome on a Mac and on an iPad, where it works by finger. Chrome and Edge can also use your computer's own fonts, once you allow it.

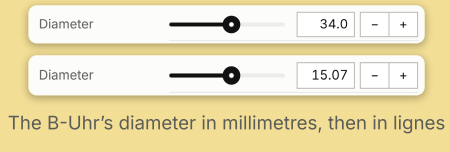
Opening a dial. A link someone sends you opens their dial, ready to change, and nothing of yours is lost: the bare address, with nothing after it, brings back the last dial you worked on here.

Sizes and units. Every length is the real length on the finished dial. The unit box, top right of the panel, sets the unit you read and type in: millimetres, points, inches, or lignes, the watchmakers' unit for movement sizes.

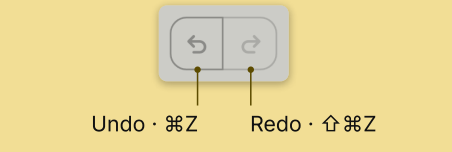
⚠ **Watch.** The unit box changes only what you read and type. The dial, its link and its files stay in millimetres.

Saving and sharing. Everything after the # is the dial itself, rewritten with every change. Bookmark the address to keep a dial, or send it to share one; Copy link, in the Export tab, copies it for you.

⚠ **Watch.** A link carries the dial, not its fonts. A font from your own computer reaches the other person only if they have it too; otherwise they see a stand-in.



The B-Uhr's diameter in millimetres, then in lignes

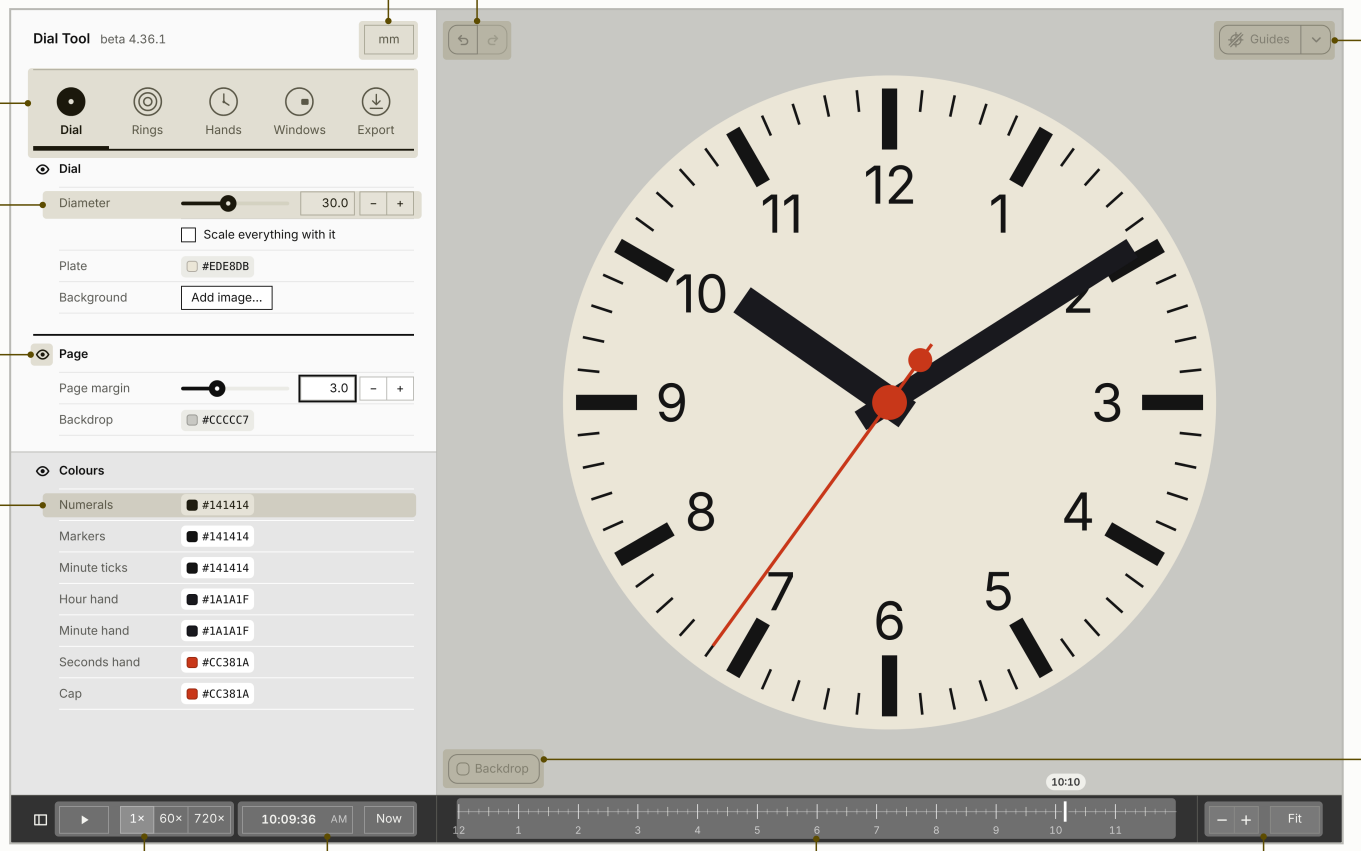


Lignes. Movements are sold by width in lignes: one ligne is 2.2558 mm, so an 11½‴ movement is 25.94 mm wide. In lignes, a dial is sized against one.

Undo and redo. Each pause after a change is a step you can go back to. On a PC the keys are Ctrl Z and Ctrl Shift Z, or Ctrl Y instead.

The whole window

Settings on the left, the dial on the right, the time along the bottom.
Five tabs choose what the panel edits; the dial redraws as you change it.



Typing numbers. A number field also does sums: +0.5 adds, x2 doubles, /3 takes a third. Useful when a drawing says “a third of the radius”.

On an iPad. Everything works by finger. Small controls answer to a press a little outside their edge, and knobs and swatches are drawn larger.

⚠ **Watch.** Guides and the backdrop are for the screen only. Nothing you see in them reaches an exported file.

Rings

Every mark, number and track on a dial is a ring.
A ring repeats one kind of thing round the centre, at one radius.

Ticks. Lines, as on a minute track.

Markers. Heavier shapes, usually for the hours.

Numerals. Numbers or words, any font.

Band. Flat colour, whole or in pieces.



The five rings together, as the tool draws them.



What makes a ring. A kind, a set of positions (how many, where the first sits, how far they spread, which ones are used), a radius, a size and a colour. Every other setting in the Rings tab refines one of these.

Reading a row. After the name come how many and of what kind, the colour, the size of one mark and the radius, in the unit you chose. The selected row opens its drawer to change them.

Giving way. A ring can skip its positions where rings above it have marks, or cut a gap round them. That is how the minute track makes room for the dots, and the bezel's ticks for its numerals.

Drawing order. The list is drawn from the bottom up, so the top row ends up in front. Drag a row by its grip to move it; hide it with its eye to see what it covers.